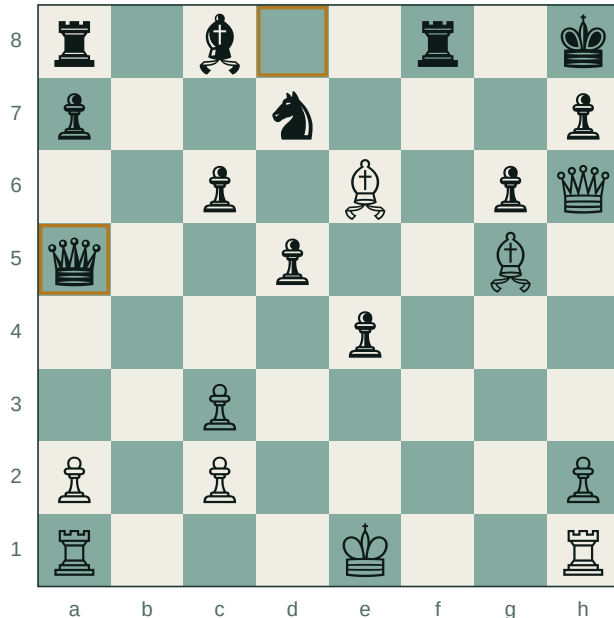


Calculated sacrifices: White, move 21

Calculated sacrifices

White to move



Previous move: 20...Qa5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

21. Qxf8+ Nxf8 22. Bf6#

21.Qxf8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From f8 it attacks king on h8 and bishop on c8. Recorded reply: **21...Nxf8**.

22.Bf6# Mate: bishop on f6 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Bishop on f6. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on h8. Absolute pin: pawn on h7.